MESA AI-NATIVE TRACK - COHORT C4
PRE-READ: Vercel Account Setup
Complete this before Lecture 1 on 18 September 2026

WHAT IS VERCEL AND WHY DO YOU NEED IT?

When you build an app on your laptop, only you can use it. Vercel takes your code from GitHub and runs it on its own servers so anyone with the URL can open your app - on any device, anywhere in the world.

In Lecture 2, you will deploy your first app to Vercel and get a live URL in under two minutes. All you need to do today is create your account.

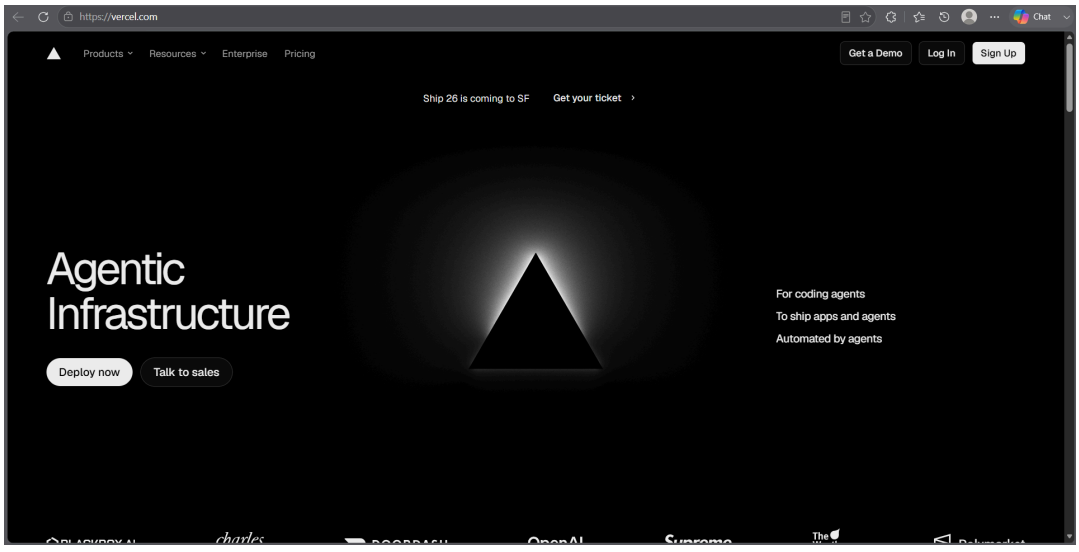
Vercel is free for the scale of projects in this course. Setup takes about three minutes - it is the simplest of the three pre-reads.

BEFORE YOU START

· Complete the GitHub pre-read first. You will use your GitHub account to sign into Vercel - no separate username or password needed.
· Do this on a laptop or desktop, not a phone.

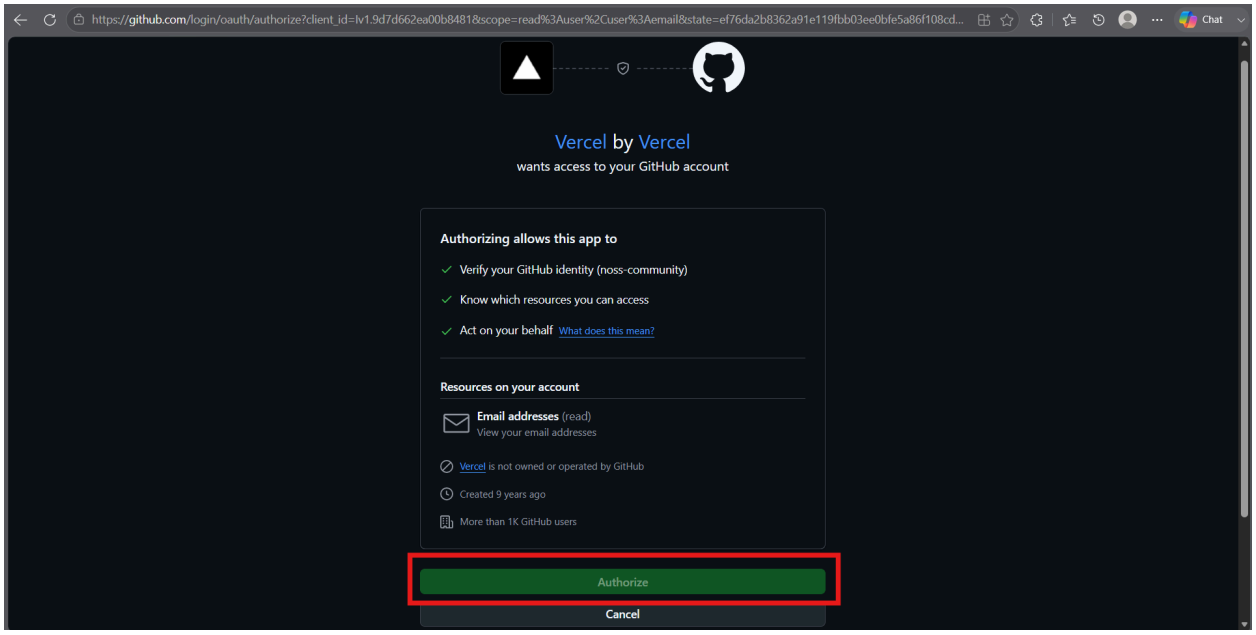
CREATE YOUR VERCEL ACCOUNT

Go to vercel.com and click Sign Up.



On the sign-up page, you will be asked what type of account this is. Select Hobby. This is the free plan - it covers everything you need for this course.

Click Continue with GitHub. Vercel will redirect you to GitHub to confirm you want to grant Vercel access to your account. Click the green Authorize Vercel button.



You will land on your Vercel dashboard.

YOU ARE DONE

That is all the Vercel setup required before Lecture 1.

You will not create a project or configure anything else today. In Lecture 2, you will connect Vercel directly to the GitHub repository you create in Lecture 1, add your environment variables, and deploy your app live - all in under fifteen minutes.

Before Lecture 2, confirm:

- ☐ Vercel account created and connected to GitHub
- ☐ You can log into vercel.com and see your dashboard